

Chapter

The Colour of Earnings on Your Plate — Food, Money and Their Fruit



Introduction: A New Angle on Food

When we talk about food, we usually think only about what is on the plate — whether it is sattvic, rajasic or tamasic. But Acharya Upendra ji asks us to look at food from a new angle: with what money did that food come?

"Your food is also connected to how you earn your money — did you ever know that?"

A deep truth lies hidden in this small question. The fruit of a meal is not decided by the quality of the food alone; the purity of the money that brought that food to you matters just as much.

1. Combinations of Earning and Eating

Acharya ji lays out a few combinations, and says each one has a different result:

"You earned black money and cooked sattvic food at home with it — the fruit will be different."

"And white money, hard-earned money, came honestly, and by mistake you ate some tamasic food too — that can also be a combination."

"Someone [earned] with a rajasic disposition, and later ate sattvic — because the doctor said so, they ate Ayurvedic food — then the result can be different."

This is the language of the three gunas: **sattvic** (pure, calm, filled with sattva), **rajasic** (full of agitation and ambition) and

tamasic (leading towards inertia and darkness). **Vritti** means a person's disposition, or the way they earn. Acharya ji's point is that **the way you earn and the quality of what you eat together decide the result.**

"Are you understanding this new angle that I am telling you?"

2. Sattvic Food from Impure Money — Will the Fruit Be the Same?

Now Acharya ji takes a stark example:

"So suppose I steal heavily outside, cause people suffering, take money through looting, and with that money I eat food, however sattvic it may be — whether I stole it, or got something rajasic through some half-baked deal, or came home myself in a sattvic state and cooked it — will this person get the same phalashruti?"

Phalashruti means the stated fruit of an action. The answer lies within the question:

"It would have been done by snatching someone's due, by doing something crooked."

However sattvic the plate may be, if it came by snatching someone's due, its fruit is not what sattvic food from pure earnings would give.

3. A Pure Life, Impure Food — Devotion Protects

Now the opposite situation. A person is honest, but circumstances are against them:

"And there was another, a hard-working person. Worked very hard, was very sattvic, their outward conduct was good. For some reason, due to prarabdha, money was short or there was none."

Prarabdha is the fruit of past karma that is destined to be lived out in this life. A wicked person deceives such a one:

"The other person is crooked, wicked. He mixed something into their food, gave them something tamasic, mixed something wrong into their food. So what is the result?"

"Their devotion, their sattva guna, their sattvic dravya-shuddhi — will it not protect them at least a little?"

Dravya-shuddhi means the purity of one's wealth and means — honest earnings. **One whose life and money are pure is protected by their devotion and sattva even from the effect of wrong food.**

4. Meerabai's Poison

To prove this point, Acharya ji gives the example of Meerabai, who was given poison:

"If this were not so, Meerabai could not have digested the poison despite being given it. Yet she digested it — through her devotion."

What could be more tamasic than poison? Yet Meerabai's devotion digested it. This is the proof of the teaching: devotion within outweighs impurity from outside.

"Are you understanding this or not? This is one more angle on food."

Summary: Key Teachings

- 1** Food is connected to earning as well. The fruit of a meal is decided not only by the quality of what is on the plate, but also by the purity of the money that brought it.
- 2** How you earn and what you eat together make the result — sattvic food from black money, tamasic food from white money, Ayurvedic food from rajasic earnings — every combination bears a different fruit.
- 3** Even sattvic food obtained by snatching someone's due does not give the phalashruti that food from pure earnings gives.

- 4 The devotion, sattva and dravya-shuddhi of a hard-working, sattvic person protect them even from the effect of wrong food.
- 5 Meerabai digested poison through her devotion. Inner purity is stronger than outer impurity.